

LOLA THOMAS

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Digital growth, optimisation & Martech professional with experience across acquisition, conversion, engagement, retention and monetisation. Combines experimentation, behavioural analytics and performance optimisation with expertise in Martech, customer journeys and measurement. Experienced in platform selection and implementation, experimentation roadmaps, and translating customer and commercial data into growth strategies.

EXPERIENCE

In Digital Marketing | Manager, Experimentation & Analytics

JAN 2024 – PRESENT

Agency role covering strategy, analytics, experimentation, lifecycle optimisation and tech stack selection, implementation and management

Financial Times (Secondment) | Performance Optimisation Manager

- **Led experimentation and optimisation strategy** for the AI-powered paywall, using personalisation, behavioural analytics and testing to optimise acquisition, engagement and monetisation, with LTV as a primary KPI.
- **Owned paywall commercial performance**, translating conversion and revenue data into experimentation roadmaps to improve subscriber conversion, retention and long-term revenue.
- **Identified and prioritised funnel opportunities**, analysing customer behaviour and conversion drop-off to develop hypotheses, size opportunities and prioritise markets, audiences and channels.
- **Built Amplitude and Looker dashboards** to monitor business and experimentation performance, forecast outcomes and support senior decision-making.
- **Owned trading and business performance**, partnering with Product, CRM, Data Science and BI to align experimentation with commercial and revenue goals.
- **Represented Experimentation in the FT's Younger Audience initiative**, shaping strategies to increase social-to-web engagement, habituality and subscriber growth.
- **Analysed dynamic LTV inputs** within the AI-powered paywall, assessing their impact on access and pricing decisions to support personalisation, monetisation and model stability.

In Digital (Agency) | Core Role

- **Led end-to-end experimentation and optimisation programmes** for media and subscription businesses, using Zephra, Piano VX, Optimizely, Purchasely and MonetisationOS to deliver 3+ A/B and multivariate tests monthly across acquisition and subscription journeys, from behavioural analysis and hypothesis development through roadmap prioritisation, implementation, QA and measurement; improving conversion by up to 40%.
- **Built LTV and product-mix models** to assess registration value versus advertising revenue and identify product combinations that maximised client revenue.
- **Built measurement frameworks** across Amplitude, GA4, Adobe Analytics and Looker, defining KPIs and translating performance into optimisation recommendations.
- **Led a subscription/paywall platform RFP**, defining requirements, managing vendor demos and procurement, and conducting website audits to inform platform selection.
- **Advised on Martech and analytics tooling**, mapping customer journeys and CDP integrations against broader measurement and business objectives.
- **Evaluated AI-powered paywall vendors**, translating technical differences and AI capabilities into clear commercial trade-offs.
- **Developed audience growth strategies** for Financial Times, News UK, Future and The Independent, using segmentation and experimentation to drive engagement and retention.
- **Awarded Best Use of Data** (Marketing Awards 2025) for contribution to Financial Times first-party data and experimentation strategy.

Smartology | Account Manager

JAN 2023 – JAN 2024

- **Managed programmatic display campaigns** across multiple industries, acting as a trusted strategic partner to senior clients; translated CPC, CTR and STR data via Google Analytics and Grafana into recommendations that improved ROI.

EDUCATION

University of Nottingham

SEP 2019 – JUN 2022

Bachelor of Engineering (Chemical Engineering) | Second-class honours, upper division (2:1)

Mill Hill County High School

SEP 2017 – JUN 2019

A Level | AAB in Mathematics, Chemistry and English Literature respectively